

## General

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### **Actuator**

The mechanism responsible for moving the read/write head in a hard drive.

### **Authentication**

Refers to the set of processes by which a user's identity is verified on a network or standalone machine to ensure that the user is authorised to have access to the resources he or she requested.

### **Bandwidth**

The data-carrying capacity of a network or bus. It is usually expressed in bits per second, bytes per second or cycles per second. In other words, the higher the bandwidth, the faster the data can be sent across the network or bus.

### **Cookie**

A piece of information, usually a text file, sent by a Web server to user's computer in response to a request from a Web browser. The browser software saves the file, and sends it back to the server when required. For example, your username for a particular site may be stored as a cookie, so the next time you visit the same page, it automatically appears in the username field.

### **DHCP (Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol)**

A protocol for automatic TCP/IP configuration which provides for static and dynamic allocation and management of addresses.

### **DNS (Domain Name System)**

The system that allows you to find a particular computer on the Internet by name instead of by IP address. Host machines running DNS server software accept queries that contain the host name (such as thinkdigit.com) and return either the IP address of the desired host, or a pointer to another DNS server that might know about the host. The resolution of host names to IP addresses occurs transparently and almost instantaneously.